Claim Selection: “What Was Said” vs. “Was It Said”

This clarification addresses a common source of confusion:

👉 Choosing the wrong claim to evaluate

Before assigning any label (True, False, Partly False, etc.), you must first identify:

What is the main purpose of the post for an average user?

This determines:

- What the actual claim is
- What should be evaluated
- What label is appropriate

Step 1: Identify the Main Purpose

Ask yourself:

👉 *If someone shares this post, what are they trying to show me?*

There are two primary claim types:

A. “What Was Said” (Content Claim)

Use this when the post is trying to inform the reader that something is **true or factual**.

This applies when:

- The statement includes a factual claim that can be verified
- The post presents information as true (even if attributed to someone else)
- The information could mislead people if incorrect

✓ In these cases, evaluate the **accuracy of the statement itself**

Important:
Even if the quote/post is real, misinformation still applies.

👉 **Authentic statement + false or misleading content = misinformation**

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B. “Was It Said” (Attribution Claim)

Use this when the post’s purpose is simply to show that someone **said or published something**.

This applies when:

- The statement is opinion, rhetoric, or not fact-checkable
- The value of the post is *seeing the statement*, not verifying it
- The claim is about whether the quote/post is real

✓ In these cases, evaluate:

👉 **Did this person/source actually say or publish this?**

Step 2: Resolve Overlap (Critical Rule)

Sometimes both are present:

- A real quote
- AND a factual claim inside the quote

👉 In these cases, **prioritize the more impactful claim**

Rule:

If the statement contains misinformation, evaluate the misinformation, not just whether it was said.

Exception: see Step 3 below

Step 3: Direction of the Post

Always check whether the post is:

- Debunking

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- Questioning
- Criticizing
- Providing context

If the post is clearly **pushing back against a false claim**, then: this pushback counts since the poster is sharing that it is MISINFORMATION

👉 It gets twisty, but evaluate accordingly 😊

Even if the false claim appears in the post- if the main purpose is to debunk, the appropriate evaluation can still be true in this case, or no evidence, or whatever the case may be.

Step 4: Where Media Fits As applied to what was said vs was it said claims

Media is RELEVANT when the main purpose of the post is to show that a source (e.g., New York Times) published or reported something.

- It shows you the supposed media
- This is materially the same kind of claim as "Modi said this"
- Only here, it is saying "the Times reported this"

So yes, your evaluation will hinge on the central claim verifying if the media screenshot or video in the post is authentic.

Key Takeaways

- Always determine the **main purpose first**
- Claim selection comes **before labeling**
- Do not default to quote authenticity if misinformation is present
- Prioritize the **most impactful claim**

EXAMPLES

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Example 1:

Content In Review

An Omani analyst, Salem Al-Jahouri, in a BBC Arabic interview that Gulf countries are facing strong pressure from the U.S. to financially support the ongoing conflict with Iran.
According to his remarks, this pressure could involve massive financial commitments from GCC nations — highlighting rising tensions behind the scenes.
However, it's important to note: these are analyst claims and interpretations, not officially confirmed policy statements from the U.S. government.
Still, the discussion reflects growing concerns about how the costs of conflict are being shared — and who ultimately bears the burden.
🌍

For full context, always refer to verified sources.

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#KashmirNews #SrinagarUpdates #BreakingNews #USANews #UKNews #EuropeNews #localcommunity

Claim Type:
Was it said

Main Purpose:
The post text clearly explains that this is analysis and not verified. The main purpose is not to claim the statements are true, but to share what was said.

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Selected Claim:
A Middle East expert analysis is asserting that Gulf countries are being pressured by Trump to contribute trillions to the current war against Iran.

Why This Claim Was Chosen:
The post clearly and explicitly states it is unknown if this claim is true...but presents it as here is what some experts are saying. Because of the presentation of the post text, the main purpose of seems to be to share the analysis.

Evaluation:
True

Example 2:

Autism Diagnosed In Girls: New Research.
There is a widespread belief in society that autism is more common in men and boys. However, a long-term study has shown that autism can be as common in girls as it is in men.

Conducted by the Karolinska Institute in Sweden... Details of the news are on our website. Gazeteses.com.tr

#gazeteses #sondakikahaber #haber #haberleri

Claim Type:

Study exists- version of 'was it said'

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Main Purpose:

The main purpose of this post is to show there is a long-term and reputable study that suggests autism may be as prevalent in girls. It is not to inform the world that there is a definitive answer here on this.

Selected Claim:

The claim is that there is/was a reputable study that is researching this and shows these suggestive results.

Why This Claim Was Chosen:

There are no exaggerated or sensationalist statements here that current science is overturned. The main purpose is to share that the question is being studied.

Evaluation:

True

Example 3:

Content In Review

Claim Type:
What was said (or a hybrid of both)

Main Purpose:
To inform the reader that the Trump administration has lifted 3.3 million Americans off food stamps (or possibly that the administration has lifted 3.3 million Americans off food stamps and Trump is widely announcing this, either is acceptable)

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Selected Claim:

The Trump administration has lifted 3.3 million Americans off food stamps.

Why This Claim Was Chosen:

The post includes a misleading factual claim. When misinformation is present and the post shares it without clarification, this becomes the most severe claim and should be selected for evaluation.

Evaluation:

False or partly false (if you included the component about Trump spreading the misinformation). Remember, just because it is true he said it does not exempt what he (or anyone else) from being evaluated as false for spreading this Misinfo.

Key Takeaway to remember when selecting your claim

If choosing a different claim would change the label, re-check your selection.

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